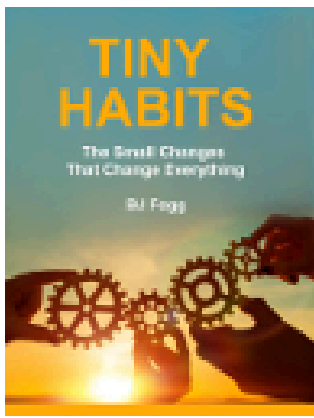




TINY HABITS

The Small Changes That Change Everything

B.J. FOGG PHD



The Big “So What”

Change is essential, but not always easy. In this book, behavioral scientist Dr. Fogg presents a proven, universal approach to help you understand all types of human behavior, and to design any behavioral change or habit.



Introduction



Everyone desires change at some point in life—be it to become healthier, to learn a new skill, or to improve our relationships and productivity. Yet, it can be hard to break a bad habit or to build a new one.

- After years of research and experiments, Fogg found that the problem with change doesn't lie with us as individuals, but with our approach. This book presents the Fogg Behavior Model (a universal model for analyzing and designing all types of human behavior), and Tiny Habits (a method to develop habits using baby steps). Together, they can help you to achieve any behavior change.
- This system has been tested with more than 40,000 people and can work for virtually any behavior at work, at home, for individuals or groups. In this summary, we've organized the various models, methods and steps into 2 parts:
 - (i) An overview of the conceptual frameworks; and
 - (ii) The specific steps for behavioral design using Tiny Habits.

KEY QUOTES



Part 1: Understanding Human Behavior



Fogg Behavior Model: The 3 Elements of Behavior (MAP)

The Fogg Behavior Model says that there are 3 universal elements behind human behavior.

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} B & = & M & A & P \\ \text{Behavior} & = & \text{Motivation} & + & \text{Ability} & + & \text{Prompt} \end{array}$$

- Motivation refers to your desire to do something. The more motivated you are, the more likely you'll perform the action.
- Ability refers to your capacity to do the action. The easier the action is, the more likely you'll do it.
- Prompt refers the cue to do something, e.g. a reminder for a meeting. No action will take place without a prompt.



A behavior will occur when all 3 elements converge. For example, you'll donate to a charity if you already wish to donate (motivation), you receive a reminder to donate (prompt) and can donate easily by replying to the text message (ability).

- Once you understand how the elements work, you can use them to design almost any behavior. If someone isn't doing what you want or expect, check if all 3 elements are present:

- Is there a prompt for the behavior?
- Is the person able to do the behavior?
- Is the person motivated to do the behavior?

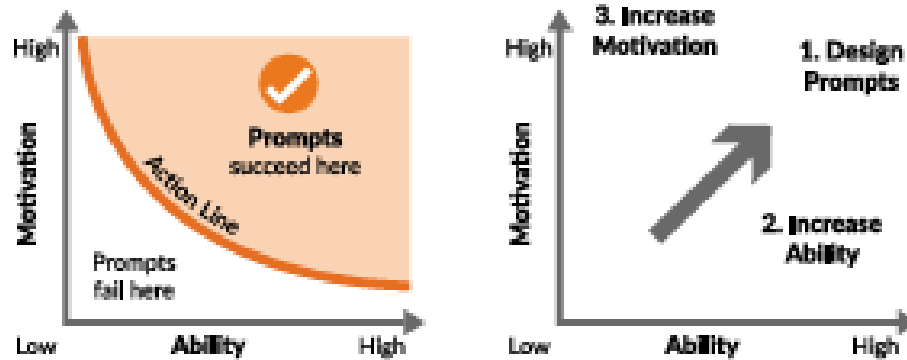


- The goal is to shift above the "action line" using MAP:

KEY QUOTES

"Behaviors are like bicycles. They can look different, but the core mechanisms are the same. Wheels. Brakes. Pedals."

Fogg Behavior Model (B = MAP)



* Adapted from Tiny Habits by BJ Fogg

- For each of the 3 behavioral elements (MAP), there are 3 sources that shape behavioral change: Person, Action and Context (PAC).

	 Person	 Action	 Context
Motivation 	Does the person want to do it?	Are there external rewards or punishments?	Does the environment affect motivation?
Ability 	Can you increase skill levels?	Can you make it smaller/easier?	Can you get tools & resources?
Prompt 	Are there internal or self prompts?	Can existing actions prompt new actions?	Can environmental cues prompt action?



Behavior Change Element #1: Motivation



Motivation refers to your desire to do a specific behavior (e.g. eat broccoli for dinner) or a set of behaviors (e.g. have a healthy diet).

- Your motivation level depends on 3 sources of motivation (PAC):
 - Person*: Do you already want to do the action?
 - Action*: Is there an external reward or punishment for doing the action?
 - Context*: How does the environment affect your motivation?



Motivation is the least reliable of the 3 elements because:

KEY QUOTES

KEY QUOTES

"Motivation is like a party animal friend. Great for a night out, but not someone you would rely on."

- We get caught in a constant tug-of-war between different factors. For example, you want to donate to a charity to make a positive impact and to enjoy tax reliefs, but hold back because you dislike the representative from the charity organization.
- You may also have conflicting motives, e.g. you want to eat a slice of chocolate cake but you don't want the extra calories.
- Motivation also comes in waves. You may get a temporary spike of motivation that drives you to quit your job or start on your New Year's Resolution, but you can't sustain your efforts once the wave passes.
- Your motivation level also fluctuates from day to day, and even moment to moment. You may feel less motivated to stick to a healthy diet during festive seasons, when you're really hungry, or when you're feeling overwhelmed at work.



The solution is to use Behavior Matching to identify the behaviors you already want to do (see Part 2 for specific steps).



Behavior Change Element #2: Ability



Generally, we avoid difficult activities. Even if you can force yourself to do something painful, you'll struggle to sustain it. That's why many people get stuck in a burst-and-bust cycle. They do something dramatic then deflate totally, e.g. do 2 hours of extreme exercise daily, then give up after 1 week because they've exhausted (or even injured) themselves.

- You're more likely to do something that's easy. So, start with tiny habits that are easy to do, then build from there. If you want to do 50 push-ups a day, start with just 1 push-up.



Examine 5 factors in the ability chain that affect your ability to perform a behavior: time, money, physical ability, mental ability, and how well it fits into your current routine.



- Identify the weakest links in the chain by asking "What's making this hard to do?"
- Then ask, "How can I make this easier to do?" by considering the 3 sources of ability (PAC):
 - (i) *Person*: How can you increase your skills so the action becomes easier to do? Examples include: doing online research, attending a course, getting a coach, etc.
 - (ii) *Action*: How can you make the behavior as tiny as possible? For example, if you want to journal daily, start by opening your journal.
 - (iii) *Context*: How can you use tools and resources to make the action easier? For example, it's easier to prepare a healthy meal if you have the right kitchen tools/equipment or a predetermined meal-plan.



Behavior Change Element #3: Prompt



Even if you have the motivation and ability, you won't do an action unless there's an effective prompt that's noticeable and appears at the right time.

- Again, there are 3 sources of prompts (PAC):
 - (i) *Person*: Relying on an internal reminder (e.g. memory or a grumbling stomach), which can be highly unreliable.
 - (ii) *Context*: Using something in your environment as a cue, e.g. an alarm going off, or a sticky note on your computer. Remove unwanted prompts (e.g. notifications from your digital devices) so your desired prompts can stand out.
 - (iii) *Action*: Using something you already do (an anchor) to prompt something you want to do (a new habit). For example, "After I brush my teeth, I will floss one tooth", or "After I have a drink of water, I will do a push-up".

KEY QUOTES

"While small might not be sexy, it is successful and sustainable."

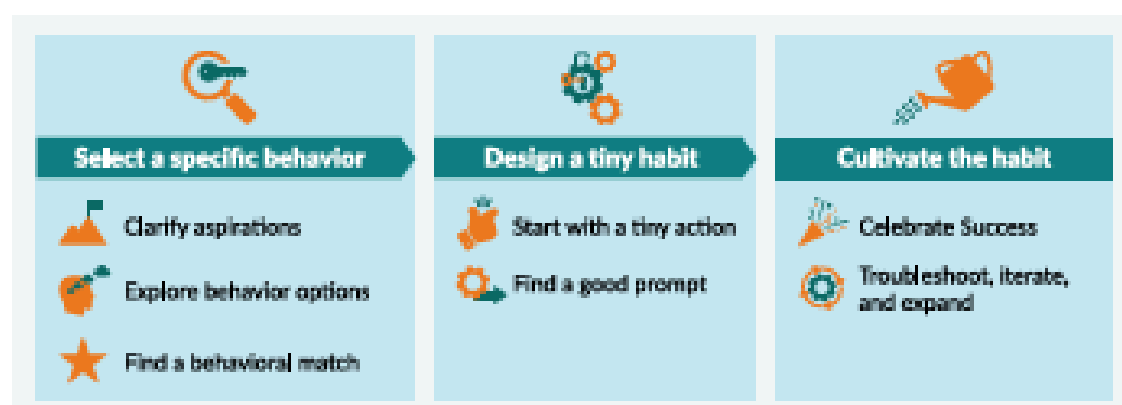


Part 2: Behavior Design and Tiny Habits



Fogg found that the best way to make a behavioral shift is to go small. Tiny habits are so effective because:

- They're fast to do, can fit into any schedule and allows you to start now.
- They're safe, unlike big or risky actions. If you make a mistake, it's easy to try again.
- They're so tiny/easy that you don't need to rely on your limited willpower.
- Yet, they add up over time to deliver dramatic changes.
- Tiny Habits are built on the Fogg Behavior Model and proven steps in behavior design. Basically, you use 7 steps to identify a desired behavior, make it tiny, fit it into your life, then cultivate it naturally.



Behavior Matching (Motivation)



Step 1: Clarify your aspirations. Write down your general aspirations or the specific outcomes you want, e.g. to “feel healthy and energetic everyday” or “lose 10kg”.



Step 2: Explore your behavior options.

- Imagine you have a magic wand that allows you to do anything you want to achieve your goal/aspiration. Jot down:
 - (i) The new behaviors you'd do once;
 - (ii) The new habits you'd develop; and

KEY QUOTES

“One tiny action, one small bite, might feel insignificant at first, but it allows you to gain the momentum you need to ramp up to bigger challenges and faster progress.”

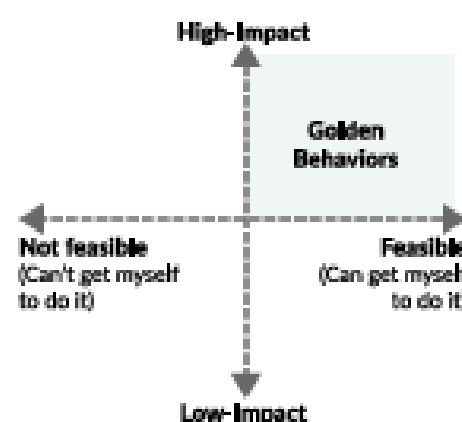
“The essence of Tiny Habits is this: Take a behavior you want, make it tiny, find where it fits naturally in your life, and nurture its growth.”

(iii) The current habits you'd stop.

- Don't confuse aspirations/outcomes with behaviors. An abstract aspiration may inspire you, but it won't tell you exactly what to do. Goals like "lose 10kg" or "save \$10,000 of emergency funds" are outcomes. Here, you're looking for specific behaviors that can lead to those outcomes, e.g. "replace ice-cream with a square of dark chocolate for dessert" or "put \$2 a day into an emergency-fund jar."

★ Step 3: Find a behavioral match. Take 20 minutes to do a Behavior Matching exercise.

- Put each idea above onto a card. Use Focus Mapping to plot:
 - (i) How *effective* the idea is for achieving your goal/aspiration. Place high-impact behaviors higher on the map.
 - (ii) How *feasible* the behavior is: can you get yourself to do it?
 - Focus on whether you *want* to do it (not if you *should*). If you really don't want to do something, put the card aside.
 - Once you've identified what you want to do, you can craft the behavior such that you'll actually do it. For example, if you want to exercise daily, the next thing is to figure out the type/level of exercise that you'd do regardless of how busy or tired you are.
- Your goal is to find the Golden Behaviors that meet 3 criteria:
 - (i) *Impact*: it can effectively help you to achieve your goal.
 - (ii) *Motivation*: you want to do it.
 - (iii) *Ability*: you can do it.



These will fall on the top-right corner of your map. They represent the things that you can do and want to do, making it much easier to do the actions and develop new habits.

KEY QUOTES

"No matter what kind of change you want to make, matching yourself with the right behaviors is the key to changing your life for good."

"What you want to do and what you can do will converge into what you most likely will do, and that's the most fertile ground for growing habits."



Design a Tiny Habit (Ability + Prompt)



Step 4: Start with the tiniest action. The easier the action, the greater your ability to perform it.

- Identify a Starter Step that's so easy that you have minimal resistance. For example, if you want to run 5km, start by putting on your running shoes. If you want to do 100 push-ups, start by doing just 1 push-up or 2 wall push-ups.
- Once you take that first step, you'll feel good about yourself and the activity, and may end up taking extra steps. Even if you stop at the Starter Step, celebrate it (see step 6 below). The idea is to lower the bar until you'll do the Starter Step even on a "bad" day.
- For example, Instagram actually started out as a location-sharing app Burbn. The founders realized that people were naturally sharing pictures of their location (the Golden Behavior) but weren't using the other features. So, they removed the extra features, made it easy for people to share photos, and relaunched the app as Instagram with a roaring success.



Step 5: Identify a good prompt to fit the behavior into your existing routine.

- Use Fogg's ABC template to design your Tiny Habits: Anchor → Behavior → Celebration.
 - (i) Anchor moment = a stable routine or habit in your life.
 - (ii) Tiny Behavior = the new habit you want to develop, scaled down into a tiny step.
 - (iii) Celebration = something to create a positive feeling ("Shine")
- Identify the series of steps that you already perform in a daily routine, then insert the tiny behavior using this formula: After I [insert anchor], I will [insert new habit]. For example:
 - (i) After I sit up in bed, I will say "It's going to be a great day!"

KEY QUOTES

"Taking the first step, no matter how small, can generate a sense of momentum that our brains love."

"Combine the right behaviors with the right chronology, and, poof, a new habit is created."

- (ii) After I make my coffee, I will open my journal.
- Pair a new habit to an anchor based on 3 criteria:
 - (i) The *physical location* where you want to build the habit;
 - (ii) The *frequency* you wish to perform the habit (e.g. 2x a day); and
 - (iii) The *theme/objective* (e.g. watering the plants and drinking water are both associated with hydration or nourishment).
- You can try these tips and variations:
 - (i) Break down a routine to find the *last step in the sequence*. For example, "after I eat breakfast" is less specific than "after I place the breakfast dishes in the sink".
 - (ii) You can *reverse the process*, i.e. think of an anchor then think of new habits you can insert.
 - (iii) Develop "*meanwhile habits*" to fill pockets of time, e.g. "After I take my place in the queue, I will think of 1 thing I'm grateful for."
 - (iv) Explore *prompts for your customers*, e.g. get a patient to measure and report his blood pressure after he sits down with his morning coffee.
 - (v) Create *pearl habits* to convert something negative to positive, e.g. "After I hear the neighbor's dog barking, I will take a deep breath" or "After I feel disrespected, I will do something nice for myself."



Nurture/Grow the Habit



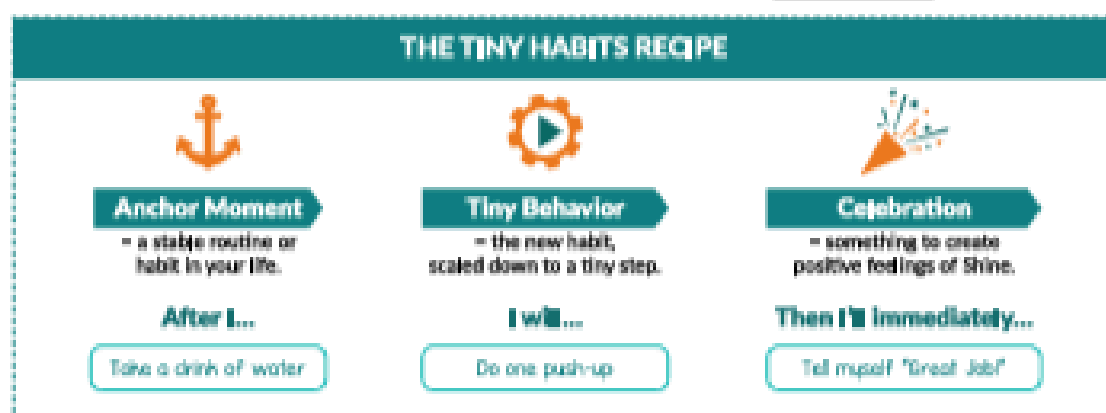
Step 6: Celebrate Success. Each time you complete your tiny behavior, make sure you celebrate it. For example, after flossing 1 tooth, Fogg would smile at himself in the mirror and say with enthusiasm "Victory!" This makes him feel good about himself and flossing his teeth.

- Emotions are what create habits. We tend to repeat things that make us feel good, and avoid things that make us feel

"Emotions create habits. Not repetition. Not frequency."

bad. Positive experiences encourage us to repeat something until it becomes automatic—that's how habits are created.

- The positive feeling must occur almost *instantaneously* for your brain to link it to the behavior. A delayed reward (e.g. treating yourself to a massage 2 days later) won't work.
- Celebrations are one of the best ways to create the positive feeling of *Shine*—that inner sense of success when you've won a contest, aced a test, or receive a standing ovation.
 - (i) Make sure your celebrations are immediate and intense.
 - (ii) Experiment to find what works for you, e.g. shouting "yay!", doing a double fist-pump, visualizing a room of people clapping for you, or thinking "Great job!"
 - (iii) Try out different ways to celebrate in public and in private.
 - (iv) Reserve a "power celebration" exclusively for habits you want to wire rapidly.
 - (v) Don't just celebrate after the action. You can also celebrate when you remember to do the habit, and while you're doing the habit.
- You can combine steps 6 and 7 into this *template*:



- To *wire a habit quickly*, repeat the ABC sequence 7-10x consecutively, e.g. sit down with your coffee, open your journal, say "yay!" with a fist-pump, then stand up and repeat the sequence. It may sound silly, but it truly helps to lock in a new habit.

KEY QUOTES

"Helping yourself feel successful is what Tiny Habits is all about."

"The feeling of success is a powerful catalyst for change."



Step 7: Troubleshoot, iterate, and expand. Tiny Habits grow and multiply naturally to create exponential results over time.

- Tiny habits tend to have a transformative effect because:
 - (i) Once you get used to a tiny habit, you'll want to increase it;
 - (ii) Each habit creates a ripple effect in the wider system of behaviors; and
 - (iii) The tiny successes build your confidence and momentum.
- Each time you use the 7 steps to form and refine a Tiny Habit, you'll progressively improve your change skills, including:
 - (i) *Behavior crafting*: Identifying specific behaviors that match you, and figuring out when/how to add new habits effectively;
 - (ii) *Self-insight*: Becoming clearer on your goals and aspirations;
 - (iii) *Change process*: Learning how to push yourself forward;
 - (iv) *Context*: Learning to design your environmental cues; and
 - (v) *Mindset*: Learning to approach change with curiosity, flexibility and patience, celebrate every success, and embrace a new identity.



Untangling Unwanted Habits



When we fail to break our bad habits, we tend to feel guilty and inadequate, making it even harder to change those habits. The best way to change an unwanted habit is to untangle it gradually in 3 phases, just like how you undo a knot.

- Create new habits. Start by forming tiny, positive habits to improve your self-identity and crowd out your bad habits.

KEY QUOTES

"Celebration is the bridge from tiny habits to big changes."

"You're a Habit Ninja, not a conformist. Find what works for you."

"Creating positive habits is the place to start, and creating tiny positive habits is the path to developing much bigger ones."

- Once you're familiar with the Behavior Model and feel confident about yourself, use the 3 elements (MAP) to stop old habits:
 - (i) Define the general habit you want to change (e.g. stop taking sugary foods), identify your behavior options, and *choose 1 specific behavior* that's the easiest to do (e.g. stop putting sugar in your coffee).
 - (ii) Remove, avoid or ignore the *prompt* for that habit (e.g. move the sugar tin away from the coffee machine to the back of your cupboard).
 - (iii) If you can't get rid of the prompt, then make it *harder* to do the habit by targeting the ability chain (time, money, physical effort, mental effort, and routine). For instance, try removing all ice-cream from your fridge so you must go out to buy ice-cream just to satisfy a craving.
 - (iv) If you can't remove a habit totally, work on *reducing* it instead, e.g. eat less sugary snacks instead of none.
- If the above still doesn't work, then swap an old habit with a new one. Whenever you encounter the prompt, adopt a different response, e.g. each time your stomach growls, reach for an apple instead of a chocolate cake.



Making Collective Changes



Behavioral change takes time. However, each positive shift will create ripple effects to improve not only your confidence, success and happiness, but also impact others around you. Fogg's approach can be summed up with 2 maxims:

- Fogg Maxim #1: "Help people do what they already want to do."
- Fogg Maxim #2: "Help people feel successful".



Our behaviors (e.g. what we eat, do or talk about) are strongly influenced by social factors.

"We shape our families, communities, and societies through our actions. And they shape us."

- As you engage in behavioral design, consider the social dynamics that affect the habits you want or don't want.
- You can also design changes to help others around you, or work with others to design positive, collective changes.



The behavior design process can also be used for group changes.

- You could approach a group change openly as the Ringleader by sharing the process and leading others through it. Alternatively, you can approach it like a Ninja by using behavioral design to subtly influence changes without others' awareness.
- Go through all 7 steps:
 - (i) Clarify your aspirations together. Even if you're operating in Ninja mode, you can still ask clarifying questions like, "Can I confirm if this is our objective?"
 - (ii) Explore behavior options together, or ask subtle questions in Ninja mode (e.g. "What do you want to see happen?")
 - (iii) Match the group with their Golden Behavior.
 - (iv) Make the Golden Behavior easy for everyone to do.
 - (v) Find a way to prompt the Golden Behavior with PAC.
 - (vi) Celebrate success.
 - (vii) Troubleshoot and iterate together.



Getting Started



Tiny Habits allow you to pick virtually any behavior, make it tiny and incorporate it into your daily routine.

- If you're still unsure where to begin, Fogg recommends starting with the 3-second Maui Habit: Once you wake up and step out of bed, say "It's going to be a great day!" This creates a subtle shift to generate rippling effects throughout your day.
- You can also try the numerous exercises and ABC recipes in Fogg's book.

KEY QUOTES

"Behavior Design is...about becoming the person you want to be—and creating the kind of family, team, community, and world we want to live in."



Other Details in the Book to Look out For

In the book, Fogg presents many examples, exercises, and illustrations of his behavior design models, methods, and insights. He shares a wide range of stories about behavioral change, from flossing one's teeth, to multiplying one's income, to reducing stress in a hospital. The book also includes appendices with a script for teaching the Fogg Behavioral Model, flowcharts for the 3 phases of untangling unwanted behaviors, 32 ways to frame success, 100 ways to celebrate, and 300 tiny habit recipes to tackle different types of challenges. For more details and resources, please visit <https://tinyhabits.com/>.

About the Author

Brian Jeffrey Fogg (born 1963) is an American social scientist and author. He's a research associate and adjunct professor at Stanford University, and the founder and director of the Behavior Design Lab. He has published several papers, authored/co-authored several books. For more details please visit www.bjfogg.com.



KEY QUOTES